Leela Varghese

Vice President, Growth and Category

Contact

Bengaluru, India
+91 00000 01001
leela.varghese@example.com

Skills

Category P&L
Pricing
Private label
Vendor negotiation
Assortment planning
Growth marketing
Team leadership
SQL

Languages

English
Malayalam
Hindi

Worked in

India
Singapore
United Kingdom

Profile

Category and growth leader with 16 years across India, Singapore and the United Kingdom. Owns a ₹1,400 crore GMV at an 11% contribution margin business and a team of 46.

Experience

Vice President, Growth and Category Apr 2022 – Present

Zentara Commerce · Bengaluru

P&L: ₹1,400 crore GMV at an 11% contribution margin · team of 46

- Owns the P&L for grocery, home and personal care.
- Chairs the weekly pricing council with finance and supply chain.
- Grew GMV from ₹820 crore to ₹1,400 crore in three years while lifting contribution margin from 7% to 11%.
- Launched private label across 9 categories; it is now 13% of category revenue.
- Cut out-of-stock rate from 8.4% to 3.1% with the supply chain team.
- Built and led a team of 46 across category, pricing and growth.
- Worked across supply chain, product, finance.

Director, Category Management Jul 2019 – Mar 2022

Zentara Commerce · Bengaluru

- Ran the grocery category at ₹310 crore GMV and renegotiated terms with 140 brands for 2.4 points of back margin.
- Set up city-level pricing in 27 cities.

Advisor, Go-to-Market Jan 2021 – Present

Halden Foods · Remote · advisory, alongside my full-time role

- Advises the founders one day a month; helped the brand enter 3 modern-trade chains.

Regional Category Lead, South-East Asia Feb 2015 – Jun 2019

Marlborne Retail Group · Singapore, Singapore

P&L: SGD 95 million category revenue across 4 markets · team of 11

- Managed SGD 95 million of category revenue across 4 markets: Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand and Vietnam.
- Moved 35% of sourcing to regional suppliers, reducing landed cost by 6%.
- Worked across sourcing, store operations.

Senior Buyer, Ambient Grocery Sep 2012 – Jan 2015

Marlborne Retail Group · London, United Kingdom

- Bought a 1,200-line ambient range for 310 stores.

Business Analyst Jul 2010 – Aug 2012

Okapi Consulting · Mumbai

- Built pricing models for 5 retail clients.

Education

MBA, Indian School of Business · 2009–2010

B.A. (Hons) Economics, St. Stephen's College, Delhi · 2005–2008